



04 | How I Feel: Emotional Landscape



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- I experience intense emotional waves but often hide them to function.
- I trust people who notice nuance more than those who demand answers.
- I use journaling, music, and solitude to self-regulate.

4.1 When I’m Overwhelmed:

- I may shut down, avoid messages, or cancel things unexpectedly.
- I need reassurance without shame — “I get it, I’m here.”
- Gentle pacing, not force, helps me return.



Based on the selected section, here's how Cody's emotional landscape impacts their interactions and relationships:

Emotional Processing:

- Cody experiences intense emotional waves but consciously masks them to maintain functionality. This is common for neurodivergent individuals, especially those with ADHD and PTSD, who may feel emotions more intensely but have learned to mask them for survival.

Trust and Understanding:

- They value people who can perceive subtle emotional nuances rather than those who demand immediate explanations. This preference likely stems from the complex intersection of being both neurodivergent and transgender, where nuanced understanding is crucial for feeling safe and accepted.

Self-Regulation:

- Cody has developed specific coping mechanisms through journaling, music, and solitude. These tools help manage the heightened emotional experiences that come with ADHD and PTSD while providing safe spaces for processing gender-related experiences.

During Overwhelm:

- They may become non-responsive, avoid communication, or cancel commitments unexpectedly. This isn't personal but rather a protective response when their multiple intersecting identities and conditions become overwhelming.

Support Needs:

- Cody responds best to shame-free reassurance and gentle, patient approaches to help them re-engage. This is particularly important given the combination of neurodivergence, trauma history, and the challenges of navigating the world as a transgender person.